

CO-53 — Easy Guide for the Convention Committee

Local working aid based on CO-1 2:8-11 and the Convention Personnel Report (CO-53). It does not replace the current official form or later branch direction.

Short answer: Who evaluates the brothers?

It is not every department overseer, and it is not the Convention Committee acting alone.

The evaluation group is:

1. Convention Committee coordinator
2. Program overseer
3. Rooming overseer
4. Confirmed Convention Committee member assistants
5. Attendant overseer
6. Cleaning overseer

For this convention, the expected group is currently:

- Adamson dela Cruz — coordinator
- Israel Vinuya — program overseer
- Wilfredo M Calaunan — rooming overseer
- Ron Mariano — coordinator assistant
- Kent Morata — program overseer assistant
- Daveson Asuncion — rooming overseer assistant
- Louie Vea — attendant overseer
- Ramon Ruiz — cleaning overseer

Other department overseers do **not** complete separate ratings for everyone. They may provide useful facts through the committee member overseeing them, but they are not members of the **CO-53** review group merely because they oversee a department.

What is the purpose of CO-53?

CO-53 helps the branch identify brothers who may qualify to serve on Convention Committees. It is not an award, popularity vote, or general performance review of every volunteer. Ratings and recommendations must

be balanced, realistic, and based on meaningful observation. (CO-1 2:8-10)

Step 1 — Prepare one master copy early

The coordinator prepares **one master CO-53**, entering the necessary names and statistics. Use full names—no nicknames or abbreviations. (CO-1 2:8)

The printed form already provides spaces for:

- Committee coordinator
- Program overseer
- Rooming overseer
- Coordinator assistant
- Program assistant
- Rooming assistant
- Attendant overseer
- Cleaning overseer
- Additional brothers who may qualify for Convention Committee service

For each person, gather the information requested on the form:

- Full name
- Date of birth and baptism
- Congregation
- Current convention assignment (“Serves as”)

Do not guess missing personal statistics. Confirm them through an authorised source or directly with the brother.

Step 2 — Circulate the master copy to the observation group

Send the master copy electronically, as soon as possible, to every member of the evaluation group listed above. This gives them time to make meaningful observations during preparation and the convention. (CO-1 2:8)

This circulation is for observation and preparation. It does **not** mean each recipient independently submits a separate final **CO-53**.

Instruction to include with each observation copy

Use this copy only for private factual observations. Any ratings you enter are provisional and will not be averaged or treated as votes. The final ratings will be agreed by the authorised evaluation group after the convention. Do not rate yourself. Keep the copy confidential, return any printed working copy to the coordinator after the review for secure destruction, and delete any electronic working copy when directed.

CO-1 requires the form to be distributed so the group can make meaningful observations and recommendations, and it requires the group to meet after the convention. It does not direct each recipient to prepare and submit a separate final report. Returning and securely destroying printed notes, and deleting electronic working copies, is a local confidentiality control rather than an additional **CO-1** reporting requirement.

Step 3 — Observe before rating

Each evaluator should observe the listed brothers sufficiently to contribute meaningfully to the final discussion. Avoid ratings based on friendship, reputation alone, one isolated incident, or second-hand impressions. (CO-1 2:10)

The four rating areas on **CO-53** are:

Rating area	Plain-language question
Balance and reasonableness	Does he exercise sound judgment and respond reasonably when circumstances change?
Organising ability	Can he plan, coordinate people and tasks, and keep important work moving?
Dependability	Does he follow through reliably and communicate when help or adjustment is needed?
Dealings with others	Is he loving, respectful, cooperative, and able to give or receive direction well?

The official ratings are:

- **A — Excellent**
- **B — Good**

- **C — Fair**
- **D — Poor**

Use the rating that realistically describes the brother; do not treat every faithful brother as automatically “Excellent,” and do not use the report to settle personal differences.

Do not calculate or average the ratings

The A–D choices are descriptive categories, not numerical scores. Do not convert them to points, average them, or treat them as votes. For example, five provisional B ratings and two provisional A ratings do not automatically produce a final B. The group must discuss the firsthand observations and agree on the one category that most accurately describes the brother. (CO-1 2:10)

If provisional ratings differ:

1. Ask what specific conduct or event supports each view.
2. Distinguish a consistent pattern from one isolated incident.
3. Consider whether each evaluator had sufficient opportunity for direct observation.
4. Consider circumstances outside the brother’s control.
5. Give appropriate weight to relevant firsthand evidence, not merely the number of matching letters.
6. Continue the discussion until the group reaches a balanced and realistic conclusion.

One lower provisional rating should not simply be outvoted. It may identify an important matter others did not observe, or it may rest on incomplete information. The coordinator should set the pace and help clarify the evidence but must not dominate the discussion. **CO-1**  provides no averaging formula or coordinator tie-breaker. If the group cannot reach a sound conclusion after careful discussion, seek direction rather than inventing a formula.

Step 4 — Consider additional qualified brothers

During the convention, the committee discusses and agrees on any additional brothers who should be included. A brother does not have to serve first as a committee-member assistant, although experience as overseer of a large department is preferred. (CO-1 2:9)

Include an additional brother only when the group has enough direct observation and information to make a meaningful recommendation.

Step 5 — Meet after the convention and agree on one evaluation

After the convention, the complete evaluation group meets prayerfully to review every person listed. The coordinator sets the pace but must not dominate the discussion. The final report should express the group’s balanced, realistic agreement. (CO-1 2:10)

Important meeting rule:

When a member of the evaluation group is being discussed, he steps out of the room. When he returns, the group normally does not reopen or change his evaluation.

For each person, agree on:

1. The four A–D ratings
2. Whether he presently qualifies as committee coordinator, program overseer, and/or rooming overseer
3. The size of convention he could serve in that position
4. Any concise, useful additional comments

Checking a qualification box should reflect present qualification—not merely potential with considerable future training.

Converting observation copies into the one final master

Use this sequence for each brother listed:

1. The brother being evaluated steps out of the room. He does not rate himself.
2. The remaining evaluators contribute relevant factual observations from their working copies or notes.
3. The group discusses any differences and agrees on the four final A–D categories, qualification boxes, convention size, and comments.
4. The coordinator records only the group's agreed conclusions on the authoritative master **CO-53**. Individual working copies are not appended to the final report.
5. The brother returns. Generally, the group does not reopen or adjust his evaluation after his return.
6. After the entire review is completed and the coordinator has confirmed that the authoritative master accurately reflects the group's conclusions, collect printed observation copies for secure destruction and direct recipients to delete electronic working copies.

The coordinator is transcribing the group's agreed evaluation—not averaging the provisional letters and not substituting his personal rating for the group's conclusion.

Step 6 — Handle a serious deficiency before submission

If the group believes a brother is seriously deficient in an area, **two members of the group** speak with him before submission. The report records the counsel given and his response. (CO-1 2:11)

The form specifically requires an explanation when “Poor” is selected for:

- Balance and reasonableness
- Dealings with others

Do not surprise a brother through a submitted report when the direction requires that he first be spoken to.

Step 7 — Coordinator completes and submits the single final report

The coordinator checks the completed master for full names, required statistics, consistent ratings, qualification boxes, convention size, comments, and any counselling record. He then sends the report to the Convention and Assembly Desk:

- **Deadline:** No later than one week after the convention
- **Subject line:** Include CO-53
- **Responsibility:** The coordinator must do this personally; it is not delegated

See CO-1 2:11.

Practical timeline for Auckland NS (TG)

When	Action
19 August committee meeting	Confirm the evaluation group, identify missing appointments, review this process, and assign preparation of the master data. Do not assign ratings yet.
As soon as appointments/data are complete	Coordinator prepares and securely circulates the master CO-53 to the evaluation group.
Before and during 30 October–1 November	Evaluators make fair, direct observations. Committee agrees on any additional candidates.
Immediately after the convention	Evaluation group meets; each member steps out while his own evaluation is discussed.
Before 8 November 2026	Coordinator completes and submits the single agreed report with CO-53 in the subject line.

Final check

- ☐ Current CO-53 form confirmed
- ☐ Full names and statistics verified

- ☐ Master copy circulated only to the authorised evaluation group
- ☐ Observation-copy instruction included; provisional letters will not be averaged or treated as votes
- ☐ Every evaluator understands whom and what to observe
- ☐ Additional candidates agreed by the committee
- ☐ Postconvention evaluation meeting scheduled
- ☐ Each evaluator steps out for his own review
- ☐ One agreed evaluation transcribed to the authoritative master; working copies securely disposed of afterward
- ☐ Any required counselling completed by two group members and documented
- ☐ One final report checked and submitted by the coordinator by 8 November 2026